

whatweretheythinking.com



www.lonelysocks.co.uk

"DID THE DOG get into my cupboard? Is there a vandal on the loose? Help, police, I've been robbed!"

After a thorough investigation, all hope of ever finding the missing twin is abandoned. Years pass—you don't heal. People come over with treats, to try and console you—it doesn't work. Your friends tell you that life just isn't fair sometimes, and recount their losses of

one of their twins—but yours was special. Nothing stops the pain and irritation of losing one of a pair. "They were born together; they serviced me for years together. How could someone take one and leave the other? How lonely they must be; they, and all like them, are meant to exist, again, together!", you tell your sympathisers.

Yes, it can be terrible to lose a sock! What can you do with one sock? A single sock has no purpose in life. It's meaningless. However, throwing it away is just not an option. So you get out a camera, take a picture and post it on Lonelysocks.co.uk. How does this help? It's the odds of probability at work here: Each sock manufacturer makes at least 10,000 identical pairs of socks. At least 5,000 people living near you probably buy clothes from the same store as you. Chances are 100 of these people bought the same pair of socks that you did. And finally, one of those 100 people has to be as careless as you, and lose one of his or her socks.

So why throw away a perfectly good sock? Just give it to someone who could reunite your sock with its twin. Right?

Ok so this is just our wildest guess at trying to figure out what the makers of this site were thinking. Tell us if you have any interesting theories, write to us at WWTT@thinkdigit.com.

their use of mobile phones to correlate between the two. They found links between a cell phone, even in a standby mode, and reduced sperm concentration and quality.

Professor Hans Evers, a past president of the society was sceptical, "It appears not to take into account the many potential confounding factors that could have skewed the results," factors such as stress levels, the type of jobs the men have and whether they smoked, which could all influence sperm count.

SHY GUYS

Homepage owners put on the couch

Owners of homepages are shy, sensitive to criticism and suffer from low self-esteem. Oh, and most of them are likely male. Researchers at the Chemnitz University of

Technology in Germany interviewed more than 300 Web page owners to arrive at the series of conclusions. To all those who feel that homepages are an altar to the ego, an exercise in



narcissism, homage to trivial-pursuits of the HTML-skilled, an ode to... you get the point, the German researches would beg to disagree. They are a challenge to the timid, they said, a tool to transform their social anxiety into happiness, moreover the majority of homepage owners present themselves as naturally as possible to the world at large.

A fact that is slightly disturbing if you are a 35-year-old Satan-worshipping-vegan with a penchant for leather. ■

Blog WATCH

Here's taking a look at a few riveting posts from the world of blogs. This month, we selected three interesting posts from Snipurl.com. Get an insight into the evolution of Google's famous doodles—from the creator himself. Muse over a fine comparison between TiVo and Windows Media Centre. Keep abreast of what's on offer at the looming fight over WLAN standard ratification

Googleblog
<http://snipurl.com/7oud>

Oodles of Doodles

My name is Dennis, and I'm the guy who draws the Google doodles. But the doodle tradition started here before I did. The first doodle was produced by (who else?) Larry and Sergey, who, when they attended the Burning Man festival in summer 1999, put a little stick figure on the home page logo in case the site crashed and someone wanted to know why nobody was answering the phone. By the time I began an internship here in the summer of 2000, the company was producing doodles on a regular basis. At the time I was a Stanford undergrad majoring in art and computer science, and, although I hadn't been hired to do anything remotely related to logo design, I eventually stumbled into my first doodle gig (Bastille Day, July 2000, for which I did a fairly boring flag motif).

Michael Gartenberg
<http://snipurl.com/7o8w>

TiVo comparison to Windows Media Center

I've spent a lot of time with both of them (and a few others) over the last few months as we're wrapping up a major report on standalone DVRs such as MCE and TiVo. There are other issues that need to be balanced. First, the PC is more flexible. If I want to store and view my pictures, music and other video content, burn to DVD, copy to a portable media player and stream that content to other devices in my home, I can do that

with the PC, and not with the TiVo. The MCE EPG is also more flexible. Try and record the West Wing on TiVo, just the 7 pm episodes shown on channel 44, not the other broadcasts. You can't do it. It's a snap on MCE (Why would you want to? To record a series according to airdates, so you can watch the episodes in order). On the other hand, my TiVo never crashed, locked up, missed a scheduled record, or any other annoying issue.

The Wireless Weblog
<http://snipurl.com/7o8x>

Big Fight Looming Over WLAN Standard Ratification

Next week's IEEE 802 plenary will surely feature fireworks between some of the big names in the next-generation wireless LAN world, including Sony, Intel, Texas Instruments, and Motorola. What's at stake is the ratification of a 802.11n WLAN standard that will enable rates of between 100 and 200 Mbits/s. Whomever is on the "winning side" of the debate could eventually see gigantic revenues in the forthcoming high-rate wireless audio, video, and data streaming marketplace. The 802.11n task group (TGN) will meet in Portland, Oregon, next week as part of the IEEE 802 plenary. It will sort through 61 proposals in search of a next-generation wireless LAN (WLAN) standard that will enable rates of between 100 and 200 Mbits/s, at least double that of current 802.11g/a standards.